

Compound words

A NEW WORD FORMED FROM THE UNION OF TWO WORDS IS CALLED A COMPOUND WORD.

A compound word is made up of two smaller words that have been joined together. There are many compound words in the English language.

Adding detail

Some words are joined to other words to add detail, making the resulting compound word more specific. For example, the word *house* can modify the word *boat* to create the new compound word *houseboat*. The word *boat* can be modified again with other words, such as *motor* and *steam*, to create new compound words that describe other types of boats: For example, *motorboat* and *steamboat*.

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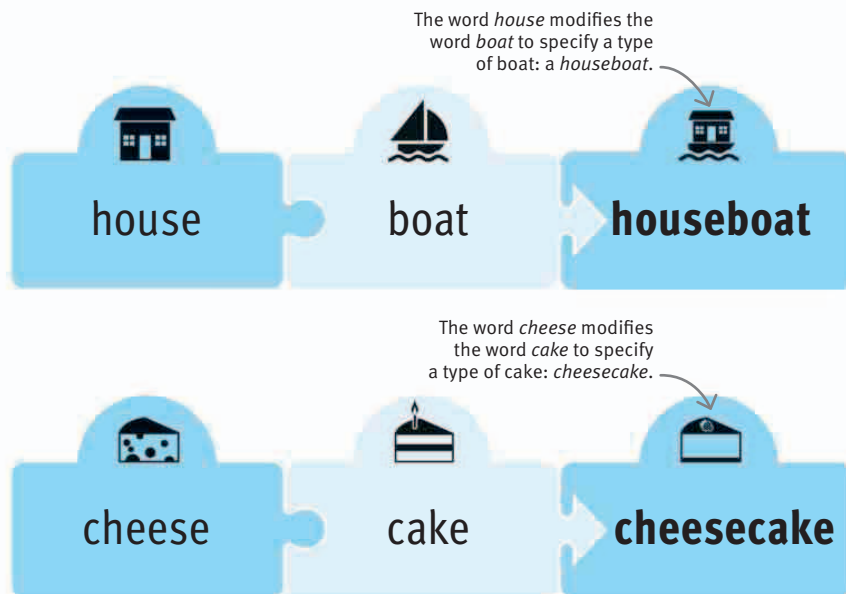
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- Most compound words are nouns. Verbs formed from two words tend to stay as two words: For example, the verb *turn around* **can be distinguished from the compound word** *turnaround*—a noun that usually refers to the act of processing or completing something.

GLOSSARY

Noun A part of speech that refers to a person, place, or thing.

Verb A part of speech that describes an action.

Word 1	Word 2	Compound word
air	craft	aircraft
baby	sitter	babysitter
book	keeper	bookkeeper
card	board	cardboard
dish	washer	dishwasher
fire	place	fireplace
ginger	bread	gingerbread
horse	shoe	horseshoe
key	hole	keyhole
news	paper	newspaper
river	side	riverside
snow	flake	snowflake
sun	rise	sunrise
tax	payer	taxpayer
wall	paper	wallpaper